scheme, cashless treatment coverage of up to Rs 5 lakh per family per year is being provided at the empanelled hospitals. In the case of more than five members, the remaining members are enrolled as a separate unit, subject to the capping of five members for each such additional unit. This is similar to the central government's Ayushman Bharat scheme and promises to offer free medical treatment to people who cannot afford to pay a hefty fee for treatment. A total of 6.01 lakh families have been registered under the Mukhyamantri Himachal Health Care Yojana- HIMCARE. Of these, 2.89 lakh families have benefited at a cost of Rs 271.65 crore.

MUKHYAMANTRI SAHARA YOJANA

As continuous care is required for those suffering from Parkinson's disease, cancer, muscular dystrophy, stroke, kidney failure, and tuberculosis, the Himachal Government has started the Mukhyamantri Sahara Yojana to provide relief to such patients. Under the scheme, economically weaker patients are provided financial assistance of Rs 3000 per month. Under the Sahara Yojana, 20,000 people have received benefits at a cost of about Rs 80 crore.



SASHAKT MAHILA YOJANA

The scheme is meant to empower rural women by providing them with an interface for socio-economic development. Under the scheme, legal literacy and women's rights awareness camps are being organised at district level, Sashakt Mahila Kendras and Anganwadi centres.

PANCHAVATI YOJANA

The main objective of the Panchavati scheme is to provide amenities like parks and gardens along with entertainment facilities to the senior citizens of the State. As part of the scheme, medicinal plants are planted in these parks and gardens. Besides entertainment equipment, walking paths and other basic facilities are provided for the elderly. Such parks also offer gym facilities for young people.

POSHAN ABHIYAN

The scheme focuses on reducing stunting by 2% and anaemia by 3% annually amongst children, adolescent girls and mothers through a life cycle approach. The scheme envisages the distribution of 20725 smart phones to all supervisors and Anganwadi workers and the distribution of growth monitoring equipment to 18925 Anganwadi centres. For effective implementation of the scheme, data is being uploaded by Anganwadi workers on the Poshan tracker application launched by the Government of India. There is a plan to celebrate Poshan Maah in the month of September and Poshan Pakhwada in the month of March. As part of the scheme, innovative activities on prevention of anaemia by the Ayurveda Department and distribution of multigrain high-protein drink mixes to the beneficiaries of Panchrukhi block in Kangra District have been undertaken.

HIMACHAL RANKS NUMBER ONE IN HAPPINESS INDEX

The time-bound implementation of welfare schemes initiated by the Jai Ram Thakur Government has brought a remarkable change in the lives of the people in Himachal. The State today ranks number one in the happiness index. According to the 2022 Happiness Survey, conducted by a HR firm, HappyPlus Consulting, people in Himachal are the happiest in India. The report claims to have used the same parameters as the UN's Sustainable Development Solutions Network report. Visionary initiatives like social security pension, welfare measures for all sections of society, empowerment of women and specially abled, environment conservation, prompt redressal of public grievances, self-employment opportunities for the youth, health insurance scheme, high literacy rate, gas connections to all households, low unemployment rate, world-class health infrastructure, zero tolerance to corruption, focus on harnessing renewable energy resources, people and village-centric schemes have changed the lives of the people of Himachal for the better.

JAN MANCH

The State Government has launched the "Jan Manch" initiative to bring public services to the doorstep of the people. The main objective of Jan Manch is to provide information about the development schemes and welfare projects initiated by the government and to develop a system in which people's grievances are redressed, thus saving the residents from making rounds of government offices. The programme envisages a high-level grievance redressal mechanism through an IT-enabled approach. Under the initiative, a day-long programme is organised in each district every month, in which the Chief Minister or State Cabinet Minister, the Deputy Commissioner, and senior officials from all departments are present. 256 Jan Manch programmes have been held in the past during which 55,249 complaints were received, out of which most of the complaints have been disposed of.

MUKHYAMANTRI SEVA SANKALP HELPLINE-1100

This ambitious scheme of the Himachal Government has greatly benefited the people of the state. A total of 4,036,679 complaints were received under Mukhyamantri Seva Sankalp Helpline-1100. Of these, 3,87,038 have been resolved till June 22, 2022.

CHIEF MINISTER RELIEF FUND

The Chief Minister Relief Fund is an emergency assistance scheme for granting relief to deserving families and individuals affected by natural calamities or loss of life of relatives due to accidents or for medical treatment of major diseases.

TRIBAL AREA DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME

The Himachal Government is committed to the welfare of people living in tribal areas. The size of the Tribal Sub Plan was Rs 567.00 crore in the year 2018-19, Rs 639.00 crore for the year 2019-20, Rs 711.00 crore for the year 2020-21, Rs 846.49 crore for the year 2021-22, and a provision of Rs 856 crore has been made for 2022-23. A budget provision of Rs.127.69 crore was spent on transportation, roads, bridges, and building construction under the Tribal Sub Plan during the year 2018-19. Rs 147.33 crores was spent in the year 2019-20, Rs 195.90 crores in 2020-21, and Rs 244.06 crore was incurred in the year 2021-22. A budget provision of Rs 287.57 crore has been made for 2022-23.

MUKHYAMANTRI GRIHINI SUVIDHA YOJANA

Due to this visionary scheme, Himachal became the first state in the country to be declared smoke-free in December 2019. With the introduction of the scheme, almost all families in the state now have gas connections. At a total cost of Rs 126.80, 3.31 lakh families have benefited from the scheme.



ENSURING EFFECTIVE IMPLEMENTATION

The state government has been laying special emphasis on time-bound execution of public welfare schemes across the state, regardless of consideration of caste colour or credo. The outcome is in the public domain. During over four-and-a-half-years stint of the present government, 412 New Gram Panchayat, 3 Municipal Corporation and various other important insitutions like health and education were opened during this period.